



3100 BCE

NARMER UNIFIES EGYPT

The two kingdoms of Upper and Lower Egypt were unified by Narmer (also known as Menes), who then became the founder of the First Dynasty, the first pharaoh of the Early Dynastic Period. His momentous achievement was commemorated in the images and hieroglyphics inscribed on artefacts such as the “Narmer Palette”, an ornamental tablet for grinding and mixing cosmetics.



▷ The Narmer palette

c. 4500 BCE Metal smelting develops from the extraction of copper from ore in fires

c. 3500 BCE Huaricanga, the first city of the Norte Chico civilization in Peru, is founded

c. 3500 BCE The earliest earthwork complex in North America is constructed at Watson Brake, Louisiana

3000 BCE

c. 3500 BCE

EARLY WHEELED TRANSPORT

As farmers in Mesopotamia domesticated larger animals, such as cattle and donkeys, they realized their potential as draught animals for drawing a plough or pulling a cart. Using solid wooden wheels, the Sumerians built four-wheeled carts for agricultural use. Chariots for military and ceremonial purposes modelled on these carts soon followed.



△ Sumerian chariot depicted on the Standard of Ur

c. 9500–3500 BCE EVOLUTION OF AGRICULTURE



The adoption of agriculture and abandonment of the nomadic lifestyle prepared the ground for the first settled civilizations.

c. 9500 BCE In the “fertile crescent” of Egypt and western Asia, people harvest and later cultivate wild grasses.

c. 8500 BCE Goats and sheep are the first animals to be domesticated as agriculture becomes established in the Middle East.

c. 5000–3000 BCE The Yangshao Culture emerges in China from the Yellow River to parts of Gansu. The people grow mainly millet.

3500 BCE Early forms of plough are invented in several different places; cattle and donkeys are used as draught animals.